Fountain Square · 2026-06-20

Blue Eighty-Eight — Handoff

Prepared 2026-06-09 · FOH: Brian Lloyd · Console: DiGiCo Q225

SHOW PAPERWORK ✓ COMPLETE

SES SHOWFILE — INVESTIGATION OPEN

SHOW DATE: JUNE 20, 2026

What's Done

DELIVERABLE	STATUS	NOTES
Blue Eighty-Eight – Input List.xlsx	DONE	17 active FOH channels, Ch 23/24 monitor-only
FOH Channel Processing.md	DONE	Machine-readable patcher input, all 17 channels
FOH Channel Processing.html	DONE	Navy/gold style; approved
FOH Channel Processing.pdf	DONE	Rendered via weasyprint; approved
apply_blue88.py	DONE	Patcher script; ran cleanly, binary verified
Blue Eighty-Eight.ses	DONE	Binary-level correct; NOT LOADING on console
pipeline-spec-fsq.md	DONE	Visual style locked; HTML structure documented

Open Problem — .ses Not Loading on Q225

Symptom: Brian loaded Blue Eighty-Eight.ses via fresh USB recall on the Q225. Console showed **"OH HL"** on Ch 9 instead of "EKIT L." No renamed channels, no EQ settings, no HPF/LPF visible across any channel.

Control: Verve Pipe .ses loaded correctly via the same fresh USB procedure — correct names and settings on-console. The strip-scoped patcher approach was confirmed working on that show.

Contradiction: Binary analysis confirms Blue88.ses is correctly patched at the strip level. 1,993 bytes differ from the template, all within the strip section. The file is not the template — it has been patched. But the console ignores it.

Binary Investigation Findings

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FSQ patcher constants (verified): STRIP1_HDR = 0x011456 STRIP_SIZE = 5383 Strip 9 range: 0x01bc8e – 0x01d195 Strip 9 in Blue88.ses — spot-check results: Name 'EKIT L' in strip: 4 copies found ✓ HPF tag 0x1d05 bidx=0: 40.0 Hz ✓ B4: -2.0 dB @ 8000 Hz SHELF ✓ B3: -3.0 dB @ 3000 Hz BELL ✓ B2: -3.0 dB @ 250 Hz BELL ✓ B1: FLAT (disabled) ✓ Do-not-write tag check: PASS ✓ File size: 2,466,215 bytes (matches template exactly) ✓ "OH HL" string: present at 0xa2c62 in template, Verve Pipe, and Blue88 → This offset is NEVER touched by any patcher. → If Q225 reads Ch 9's display name from 0xa2c62, it would show "OH HL" for BOTH Verve Pipe and Blue88. But VP shows correct names. Contradiction. Verve Pipe .ses vs template: 1,862 bytes differ, ALL within strip section. Blue88 .ses vs template: 1,993 bytes differ, ALL within strip section. → No differences above STRIP_END in either file. Same region, same approach.
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Leading hypothesis: There is a structural or ordering difference in how the Blue88 patcher writes EQ/name data relative to Verve Pipe's patcher that causes the Q225 to silently ignore or fail to parse the strip. The byte values are correct but the Q225's parser may require a specific field ordering or a structural tag the patcher isn't writing.

Proposed Next Steps

1. **Minimal test:** Build a test .ses that renames ONLY Ch 9 to "EKIT L" — no EQ, no HPF writes. Load it on the Q225. If the name appears, the problem is in the EQ writes. If it doesn't, the problem is in name-writing.
2. **Diff Blue88 vs. Verve Pipe strip-by-strip:** Compare strip 9 of both files byte-for-byte. Any structural byte that Verve Pipe has and Blue88 doesn't — especially non-EQ tags — is the suspect.
3. **Console-save comparison:** Open brian fsq start.ses on the Q225, make one manual change on Ch 9, save back to USB. Diff that console-saved file against the patcher output to see which tags the console actually writes vs. what we write.
4. **Check apply_channel call order:** Verve Pipe's patcher calls name → HPF → LPF → EQ. Blue88 does the same via apply_channel(). Verify there's no ordering side-effect at the TLV level where a later write invalidates an earlier one.
5. **Fallback:** If the .ses issue isn't resolved before load-in on June 20, the PDF show paperwork is complete and self-sufficient — dial everything in manually at soundcheck.

Channel Summary — Active FOH Channels

CH	NAME	WAS (TEMPLATE)	HPF	B4	B3	B2	B1
9	EKIT L	GUITAR 3	40	−2 @8k SHELF	−3 @3k	−3 @250	FLAT
10	EKIT R	KEY 1	40	−2 @8k SHELF	−3 @3k	−3 @250	FLAT
11	BASS DI	CONGA 1	40	−2 @5k SHELF	−2 @800	−3 @250	FLAT
12	BASS KEYS	CONGA 2	80	−2 @6k SHELF	−2 @1k	−3 @250	FLAT
13	GTR 1	BONGO	120	−2 @8k SHELF	−3 @3k	−4 @300	−4 @150
14	GTR 2	VOCAL 4	120	−2 @8k SHELF	−3 @3.5k	−4 @350	−4 @150
17	KEYS	STAR	80	−2 @10k SHELF	−2 @3k	−3 @250	FLAT
18	SAX 1	Nearfield R	150	−3 @10k SHELF	−3 @1.2k	−3 @350	FLAT
19	SAX 2	Kick In	150	−3 @10k SHELF	−3 @1.2k	−3 @350	FLAT
20	PERC 1	Snare Top	150	−2 @10k SHELF	−3 @3k	−3 @350	−4 @200
21	PERC 2	Rack 1	200	−2 @10k SHELF	−3 @3k	−4 @400	FLAT
25	WAYNE	Snare Bottom	120	−2 @10k SHELF	−3 @2.5k	−4 @250	FLAT
26	BRENT	Hat	120	−2 @10k SHELF	−3 @2.5k	−4 @250	FLAT
27	CHRIS	Rack 1	120	−2 @10k SHELF	−3 @2.5k	−4 @250	FLAT
28	JOHN	Rack 2	120	−2 @10k SHELF	−3 @2.5k	−4 @250	FLAT
29	CARRIE	Rack 3	120	−2 @10k SHELF	−3 @2.5k	−4 @250	FLAT
30	MD	OH Ride	120	−2 @10k SHELF	−3 @2.5k	−4 @250	FLAT

Ch 23/24 skipped — monitor-only. HPF in Hz. EQ: gain dB @ freq Hz, type. FLAT = band disabled.

File Index — Show Folder

FILE	DESCRIPTION
Blue Eighty-Eight – Input List.xlsx	Master input list, all channels
Blue Eighty-Eight – FOH Channel Processing.md	Machine-readable patcher input
Blue Eighty-Eight – FOH Channel Processing.html	HTML source for PDF (canonical)

Blue Eighty-Eight – FOH Channel Processing.pdf	Show paperwork — approved, print-ready
apply_blue88.py	Q225 .ses patcher script
Blue Eighty-Eight.ses	Q225 showfile — binary correct, console load unresolved
Blue88 – Handoff.pdf	This document